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Disagree Wisely, Inc.

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February 18, 2026

On behalf of Disagree Wisely, Inc. I am pleased to submit this Letter of Intent to serve as a subcontractor to North Carolina State University for the project titled “Forming Intellectual Virtue Through Reasoned Dialogue in Required Undergraduate Courses” in response to the Educating Character Initiative grant opportunity.

Disagree Wisely is a nonprofit educational technology organization dedicated to cultivating intellectual virtue through structured civil discourse and constructive engagement with opposing viewpoints. Disagree Wisely provides access to and support for Sway, an AI-facilitated dialogue platform that pairs students who hold opposing views for structured conversations with real-time AI facilitation. Since its launch in 2024, Sway has reached over 8,500 students at over 80 institutions, with 90% of students reporting feeling comfortable sharing their sincere views on the platform.

Under this subaward, Disagree Wisely commits to providing Sway platform operations, faculty training and support, assistance with faculty recruitment, and research and data integration to enable successful implementation of the thinkARGUMENTS + Sway (TA+S) pedagogical model across the expanded ECI faculty cohort.

Scope of Work:

Sway Platform Operations & Technical Support: Maintain and scale the Sway platform to support 200 faculty and their students (combined FIPSE + ECI cohorts) across diverse institutional contexts, including public universities, private universities, HBCUs, and community colleges. Provide technical support, troubleshooting, and cross-institutional student pairing.

Faculty Training, Onboarding & Support: Co-design and deliver the Summer 2027 workshop at UNC-Chapel Hill’s School of Civic Life and Leadership (SCiLL). Conduct individual

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onboarding consultations and provide ongoing implementation support for ECI-funded faculty Fellows. Develop implementation resources including syllabi templates, assessment rubrics, and instructional videos.

Faculty Recruitment & Outreach: Support the recruitment of faculty Fellows from diverse institutional contexts through outreach communications and conference presence. Coordinate with NC State project leadership on Fellow selection and application review.

Research, Assessment & Data Integration: Support the ICDC longitudinal study through research on the cultivation of intellectual virtue through Sway dialogue, data infrastructure for cross-institutional analysis, and anonymized data sharing with NC State's assessment team. Provide faculty-facing reporting and analytics tracking student engagement and progress.

Project Period and Budget:

The total subaward budget for the project period (August 1, 2026 through July 30, 2029) is $233,450, allocated as follows:

Personnel Salaries: $203,000

Fringe Benefits (15%): $30,450

Year 1 (Aug 2026–Jul 2027): $166,750

Year 2 (Aug 2027–Jul 2028): $33,350

Year 3 (Aug 2028–Jul 2029): $33,350

Approximately 70% of costs are allocated to Year 1 to support intensive platform operations, workshop delivery, and faculty onboarding, with 15% in each of Years 2 and 3 for ongoing support. A detailed itemized budget and budget justification are provided separately.

Disagree Wisely has the organizational capacity, technical infrastructure, and pedagogical expertise necessary to execute this subaward successfully. Our team includes deep expertise in AI system design, educational technology, philosophy of argumentation, and civil discourse pedagogy. We are an existing partner in the FIPSE-funded Integrating Civil Discourse into the

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Curriculum (ICDC) consortium, and this ECI-funded work complements and extends that initiative.

This ECI-funded work complements and extends the existing FIPSE-funded ICDC consortium by doubling the number of faculty trained (from 100 to 200) and consequently doubling the number of students reached with evidence-based character formation pedagogy.

Disagree Wisely, Inc. is a nonprofit corporation organized under the laws of the State of Florida. We are applying for tax-exempt status under section 501(c)(3) of the Internal Revenue Code and expect this determination to be received prior to the grant period beginning August 1, 2026.

Please contact me at cullen@heterodoxacademy.org if you require any additional information.

Sincerely,

Simon Cullen, Ph.D.

Co-Founder and President, Disagree Wisely, Inc.

Faculty Research Fellow, Heterodox Academy

Visiting Research Professor of Civil Discourse & AI, UNC-Chapel Hill School of Civic Life and Leadership